Larkspur Labs: Performance Reviews and Promotions

1. The review cycle

Larkspur Labs runs performance reviews twice a year, in April and in October. Each cycle takes about four weeks from self-review to the final conversation with your manager.

Reviews happen in PeopleHub. Employees still in probation take part in their 90-day check-in instead of the review cycle.

The steps are: 1) self-review (1 week), 2) peer feedback (1 week), 3) manager review and calibration (1 week), 4) a review conversation with your manager (1 week).

2. Feedback and ratings

Peer feedback: you choose 3 peers to give feedback, and your manager can add one more. Peer feedback is shared with you without names.

Ratings use four levels: Exceeds expectations, Meets expectations, Partially meets expectations, and Does not meet expectations.

Calibration: managers in each department meet to compare ratings, so that the same performance gets the same rating across teams. Your manager tells you your final rating in your review conversation.

If you get Partially meets or Does not meet expectations, you and your manager agree a written support plan with goals for the next 3 months.

3. Promotions and pay reviews

Promotions are decided in the October cycle only. Your manager nominates you with a short written case based on the career framework in Notion. Promotions take effect on 1 November.

Salary reviews happen once a year, in the April cycle. Pay increases take effect from 1 May and appear in your May payslip.

Pay increases depend on your rating, your position in the salary band for your level and the company budget for that year. Salary bands for every level are published in PeopleHub.

If you disagree with your review outcome, raise it with your manager first, then with your department head or the People team within 10 working days.